

LANDSLIDE

What Should You Do Before a Landslide

Know Your Risk

Learn about landslide risks in your area. Landslides happen in every US state and territory. Any mountain or hill can have a landslide.

A previous landslide is the biggest risk factor for another landslide.

Even a few inches of slope movement can damage your home, break septic, sewer, water lines and crack your home's foundation.

Know the causes and signs of landslides:

Causes of Landslides

Natural causes

Heavy rain

Waterlogged soil

Wave or river erosion

Steep slopes

Earthquakes

Wildfires

Signs of Landslide Activity in Your Area

Tilted or bent trees

Sagging utility lines

Springs that develop in new places or streams that stop flowing suddenly

Cracks in ground

Earthen mounds on a slope

Sunken or broken roads

Cracks in the streets, walls, floors, and around windows or doors

Leaking or broken pipes

Floors, posts, or walls that are tilted

Windows or doors that suddenly begin to stick

Movement of soil away from foundation

Watch the patterns of storm-water drainage near your home. Note the places where runoff water converges. This may indicate an area prone to landslides.

Reduce Your Risk

Consider consulting with a professional to have your land surveyed. There are ways to reduce your landslide risks.

Avoid making cuts in steep slopes.

Plant more native trees and plants on slopes, avoid cutting them down.

Direct rainwater that falls on your roof or driveway away from slopes at risk of landslides.

Make Plans to Stay Safe

Learn about the emergency response and evacuation plans for your area.

Develop your own emergency plan for your family or business.

If You Think a Landslide Could Happen

Evacuate! Getting out of the path of a landslide or debris flow is your best protection.

Once you are safe:

Call and report emergency.

Inform affected neighbors. Your neighbors may not be aware of the danger.

Understand Landslide Alerts

Landslide Advisory: An advisory states the potential for landslides in a certain area.

Landslide Watch: A watch means that landslides are possible. People in a Landslide Watch area should monitor weather conditions and consider avoiding the area.

Landslide Warning: Warnings indicate that landslides are occurring. Avoid the area. If you are in the landslide area, evacuate.

What Should You Do During a Landslide

Prepare tour to hilly region according to information given by weather department or news channel.

Move away from landslide path or downstream valleys quickly without wasting time.

Keep drains clean,

Inspect drains for - litter, leaves, plastic bags, rubble etc.

Keep the weep holes open.

Grow more trees that can hold the soil through roots,

Identify areas of rock fall and subsidence of buildings, cracks that indicate landslides and move to safer areas. Even muddy river waters indicate landslides upstream.

Notice such signals and contact the nearest Tehsil or District Head Quarters.

Ensure that toe of slope is not cut, remains protected, don't uproot trees unless re-vegetation is planned.

Listen for unusual sounds such as trees cracking or boulders knocking together.

Stay alert, awake and active (3A's) during the impact or probability of impact.

Locate and go to shelters,

Try to stay with your family and companions.

Check for injured and trapped persons.

Mark path of tracking so that you can't be lost in middle of the forest.

Know how to give signs or how to communicate during emergency time to flying helicopters and rescue team.

What should don't do

Try to avoid construction and staying in vulnerable areas.

Do not panic and loose energy by crying.

Do not touch or walk over loose material and electrical wiring or pole.

Do not built houses near steep slopes and near drainage path.

Do not drink contaminated water directly from rivers, springs, wells but rain water if collected directly without is fine.

Do not move an injured person without rendering first aid unless the casualty is in immediate danger.

What Should You Do After a Landslide

Stay Safe

Stay away from the site. Additional slides are likely.

Without entering the direct slide area, check for injured and trapped people. Direct trained rescuers to their locations.

If you evacuated, listen to authorities to find out if it is safe to return.

Avoid damaged or fallen power lines, poles, and downed wires. They can electrocute you.

Check your home and property for damage. Consult with a professional if needed.

Stabilize your land with landscaping and plants.

Take Care of Yourself

It's normal to have a lot of bad feelings, stress, or anxiety after a disaster or other emergency.

Eat healthy food and get enough sleep to help you deal with stress.